Your 3-Month Plan: Geopolitics Channel, Shorts/Instagram and UPSC

13 Oct 2026 – 17 Jan 2027 · Print and keep · Tick the boxes as you go

Plan on one page

1. **The ₹40k contract is your income for these 3 months.** YouTube and Instagram will pay about ₹0 until mid-January. That happens to every new channel. It does not mean you failed.
2. **The goal is to build the machine.** By mid-January you will have 11 long videos, about 18 Shorts, 11 UPSC note pages, a trained voice clone, and a routine that fits in 19 channel hours a week.
3. **Mon–Sat:** UPSC 07:30–08:30 · Ayush 10:00–14:00 (Mon–Thu) · newspaper 15:00 · channel 15:30–18:00 · **stop at 18:00**. **Sunday is fully off.**
4. **Each week:** 1 long video (Saturday 18:00), 2 Shorts (both go on Instagram, 1 goes on YouTube), 1 UPSC note page and 1 handwritten Mains answer.
5. **Claude and ElevenLabs do about 30–40% of the work:** research, drafts and voice. You choose topics, check facts, add your own analysis and edit. That part keeps the channel safe and able to earn.
6. **If a week goes wrong, the video moves to next Saturday.** One late week is normal.
7. **₹1.1 lakh a month is an 18–24 month goal.** That is the good case, from content plus editing work. Your first milestones are a paid editing client, then 500 subscribers + 3,000 watch hours.
8. **This week:** read your contract, order a mic, pick a name and install QGIS. This takes about 3 hours in total.

Plan window: 13 Oct 2026 – 17 Jan 2027 **Written for:** a skilled video editor and UPSC aspirant who works 4 days × 4 hours a week with Ayush's team

> **How to use this plan.** Read it fully once. After that, open only three parts each week: the box above, the **timetable** (Section 3.2) and **this month's checklist** (Section 5). Use the other sections only to look things up. Numbers marked *(est.)* are estimates, not promises.

Words used in this plan

- **RPM:** the money *you* receive for every 1,000 views, after YouTube takes its share.
- **YPP (YouTube Partner Program):** the program you must join before YouTube pays you anything.
- **Watch hours:** the total hours people spend watching your *long* videos. Shorts do not count.
- **CTR (click-through rate):** the % of people who saw your thumbnail and clicked on it. For a new channel, 3–5% is normal and 5% or more is good.
- **PYQ:** a previous year question from the UPSC exam.
- **Mid-roll:** an ad in the middle of a video. Only videos of 8+ minutes can have one.
- **Affiliate link:** a link that pays you a small cut when someone buys through it.
- **Retainer:** a fixed monthly fee a client pays you for regular work.

0. This week (13–18 Oct): about 3 hours

☐ **Read your contract with Ayush/Khabargaon.** Look for these words: "exclusivity", "non-compete", "conflict of interest", "moonlighting", "intellectual property", "assignment", "work product" and "confidentiality". Also look for any rule about side projects or freelance work. News brands often say that anything you create "during the term" belongs to them. Khabargaon also makes world-news content itself, so this check matters.

- Then ask the team politely for **one line in writing**: *"A personal geopolitics channel made outside contract hours, on my own equipment, is mine and not a conflict."* Do not publish anything until you have it.

☐ **Order a USB mic.** The Fifine K669B or Maono PM461TR cost about ₹2,000–2,500.

☐ **Pick a channel name in one 30-minute sitting.** The list is in Section 2. If two names have free YouTube and Instagram handles, take the shorter one. You can rename the channel later.

☐ **Install QGIS (free) and download the Natural Earth file "Admin 0 – Countries (India POV)"** (`ne_10m_admin_0_countries_ind`, v5.1.1).

- **Optional:** if the mic arrives before 18 Oct, try ElevenLabs Starter. It costs $1 for the first month, and the offer ends 18 Oct.
  - Make an Instant clone.
  - Generate a 60-second Hinglish script two ways: English words in Roman script, and English words in Devanagari.
  - Keep whichever sounds more like you. If the mic is late, skip this and test in Week 1.

Plan B: use this if the contract says no, or you have no clear yes in writing by 25 Oct.

- Don't publish anything. Keep your UPSC hours the same.
- If the contract says your work during the contract belongs to them, only do setup until it ends: the voice clone, templates and map library. Give the spare hours to UPSC.
- If it only forbids publishing, make evergreen videos (chokepoints, Siliguri, BRI, Quad) and keep them private. When the contract ends, launch with 3–4 videos ready.
- In both cases, you can offer Khabargaon a **paid geopolitics explainer segment**. That turns the conflict into income.

1. The honest picture

1.1 Your two money targets at a glance

Target	What it really needs	When it is realistic
₹60k/month from long videos	17–30 lakh views a month at a realistic ₹20–35 RPM (est.)	Ads alone rarely reach this. In the good case, typical ad income after 18+ months is ₹10k–30k a month (est.)
₹50k/month from Shorts + Instagram	In India, Shorts pay about ₹1–5 per 1,000 views, and Instagram pays ₹0 per view. The money comes from brand deals, and those need 25–50k engaged followers	9–18 months, if growth goes well (est.)

The full math is in the **Appendix**. Read it once, then leave it alone.

My honest view:

- In the good case, ₹1.1 lakh a month in *total* income (content plus editing) is possible in about **18–24 months**.
- ₹1.1 lakh from content *alone* is a **2–3 year** goal, even in the good case (est.).
- For comparison, a real UPSC channel with 22,000 subscribers ("Crack UPSC With Me") is estimated to earn about ₹25k–60k a month from everything combined.
- None of this can happen in 3 months. By mid-January, the most likely result is 200–1,000 subscribers and ₹0 from YouTube. That is normal, and it does not mean you failed.

1.2 What is realistic, and when

	By mid-Jan 2027 (most likely)	6–12 months	12–24 months
YouTube subscribers	200–1,000	Base 500–3,000 · Good 3,000–10,000 (est.)	Good case: 10,000–50,000 (est.)
YouTube money	₹0	You will probably join the fan-funding tier (small money). In the good case, the ads tier may arrive near month 12	Most good cases reach the ads tier. Typical ad income is ₹10k–30k a month (est.). ₹60k from ads alone is a top outcome
Instagram money	₹0	₹0–15k	₹10k–40k. The top of the range needs 25–50k followers (est.)
Your real income	₹40k contract	Contract or editing work + small deals	A mix of income streams (Section 8.4)

1.3 The goal for these 3 months: build the machine

By mid-January you should have:

1. A trained voice clone, a template kit, and a checked India map file with base maps.
2. **11 long videos and about 18 Shorts**, published on a fixed schedule.
3. A routine that fits in **19 channel hours a week**.
4. **11 UPSC note pages**, about 12 handwritten Mains answers, and a chosen UPSC path.
5. Your first few hundred real viewers across YouTube, Instagram and Telegram.
6. 15 freelance pitches sent, and a clear plan for February income.

1.4 Your first milestones

1. **Your first rupee outside the contract:** a paid editing job, in Month 2–3 or February.

2. **The YouTube fan-funding tier.** You need 500 subscribers, 3 uploads in the last 90 days, and either 3,000 watch hours or 3M Shorts views. These rules **do not change** in 2027.
    - 3,000 hours is about 36,000 long-video views at 5 minutes of average watch time, or 45,000 views at 4 minutes. By mid-January you will most likely have 100–1,000 hours.
    - This tier builds trust; it does not bring real income. Memberships start cheap and YouTube keeps about 30%, so 10 members earn only a few hundred rupees a month. At first, expect ₹0–2,000 a month (est.).
    - Its real value is that it unlocks YouTube Shopping.
3. **If you ever reach 1,000 subscribers and 4,000 watch hours, apply for YPP that same day.** That is about 48,000 views at 5 minutes each. Don't wait for a review day.
    - YouTube takes about a month to review an application.
    - If you reach it in January, apply at once. After 1 Feb, YouTube may not use the old rules for you.

The full money ladder is in Section 8.3.

2. Positioning: who you are on YouTube

Niche: map-first geopolitics explainers for Hindi-speaking UPSC aspirants and curious young Indians. Every video answers one question: **"India pe asar kya hai?"**

Language: Hindi-first Hinglish.

- Speak conversational Hindi, but keep English terms like "strategic autonomy", "chokepoint" and "Global South".
- Use English labels on maps.
- Add English subtitles from day 1.
- Test titles and thumbnails with YouTube's **Test & Compare** tool. It works on desktop only and needs "advanced features" turned on. Use **2 versions**, and YouTube picks the winner by watch time.

Why Hindi:

- The biggest UPSC IR channels (StudyIQ, Drishti, Unacademy World Affairs) are in Hindi or both languages.
- English pays more per view, but you would be competing with WION, Firstpost and big global channels.
- Your voice clone will also sound most natural in Hindi.

5 name ideas. Check that both handles are free, and that nobody already uses the name as a brand.

Name	Meaning and feel
Naksha Nazar	"Map view". Short, easy to remember, and shows your map style
GeoSutra	"The thread or formula of geopolitics". Works in Hindi and English
Duniya Map Par	"The world on a map". Says exactly what you do
Nakshe Ki Baat	"Talk of the map". Friendly and conversational
Sarhad Se Samandar	"From border to ocean". Covers land and sea

Avoid names that use "Chanakya", "Kootneeti", "Gravitas" or "Vantage", because these are already brands. Put your **real name** in the About section, for example: "by [Your Name], UPSC aspirant and video editor".

Your edge: four things that no single channel combines today

1. **UPSC-grade accuracy.** Every claim is checked against primary sources: MEA, PIB, UN, PRS.
2. **Editor-level visuals.** Animated maps, timelines and data callouts. Most Hindi IR channels use a smart-board or a talking head.
3. **The UPSC corner.** The last 60–90 seconds of every video give the syllabus code, one Mains question, 5 keywords, the places to know for Prelims, and the linked PYQ.
4. **A calm tone.** Most Hindi defence content is loud. You are the calm voice that shows its sources.

Video structure (use it every time)

1. Open on a moving map (0–20 seconds): the conflict, the stakes and one question.
2. Your reusable **8–10 second on-camera intro**, in your real voice (Section 5, Week 1).
3. "India pe asar kya?" within the first 60 seconds.
4. Three acts: history → geography → now.
5. "What next": 2–3 possible scenarios.
6. The **UPSC corner (60–90 seconds), recorded on camera in your real voice**.

Length:

- Videos 1–3: 8–10 minutes, while you learn the pipeline.

- From Video 4: 10–15 minutes. Videos of 8+ minutes can carry mid-rolls later.
- The year-recap video on 2 Jan: 15–18 minutes.

Shorts: same channel, fewer on YouTube.

- Make **2 Shorts a week**, cut from that week's long video.
- Post **both on Instagram**. Post **one on YouTube**: the first one in that week's list in Section 6.2.
- **Why only one on YouTube:** a study of 18,000 channels found the best growth when Shorts were 25–40% of uploads. Above about 55%, the audience for long videos got smaller. Every YouTube money tier depends on long-video watch hours.
- At a monthly review you may start posting both on YouTube, but only if each long video's views are not falling.
- **A separate Shorts channel:** not now. Look at the question again at the decision point in Week 13.

Thumbnail formula: one map + one red arrow or highlight + one face or flag + 2–4 words. Use faces only from the safe sources in Section 10.

Title rules:

- 40–60 characters, with the main keyword first.
- The title and thumbnail must match what the video delivers. YouTube enforces this strictly for news videos in India.
- **Status-word rule:** some titles contain a "status word" such as band, signed, khatam or toot raha. Within 24 hours before publishing, check that word against a primary source.

3. Weekly time budget and timetable

3.1 Hours per week

Activity	Hours a week
Ayush/Khabargaon contract	16
Commute (if you go to an office)	__ fill in
Channel work (long video + 2 Shorts)	19
UPSC study	10.5
Weekly review	0.5
Total	**46 + commute**
Sleep	7.5–8 hours a night
Free time	All of Sunday, and every evening after 18:00

- About 3 hours of channel reading each week also counts as GS2 study. Treat it as a bonus, and don't count it as UPSC time.
- **Ceiling: 46 hours a week.** Anything new must replace something.
- **Optional freelance work (Months 2–3):** at most 3 hours a week. In any week you do it, make only 1 Short. The rules are in Section 8.2.

If a week gets too heavy, cut in this order:

1. The second Short.
2. Extra polish on the video.
3. Move the long video to next Saturday.

Never cut sleep, Sunday, or the 15-minute UPSC minimum.

Rules for when life happens:

- **A missed week:** if the long video isn't finished by Saturday 13:00, publish it next Saturday instead. Don't work past 18:00 to rescue it. Later topics move back one week, and the last one is dropped. One late week is normal.
- **Ayush work runs late:** if it goes past 14:00, that day's channel block gets shorter by the same amount. Never work past 18:00 to catch up.
- **A long commute:** if it takes more than 45 minutes each way, change three things. The Mon–Thu channel block becomes 16:00–18:00, you make only 1 Short a week, and you read the newspaper during the commute.

3.2 Sample week

This assumes Ayush work is Mon–Thu, 10:00–14:00. Move the blocks to fit your real days.

Day	07:30–08:30	10:00–14:00	15:00–15:30	15:30–18:00
Mon	UPSC: static subject	Ayush	Newspaper	Confirm the topic (5 min) → Claude source brief → read sources → write your main argument
Tue	UPSC: static subject	Ayush	Newspaper	Claude draft → your rewrite (at least 3 [MINE] points) → start the fact-check
Wed	UPSC: static subject	Ayush	Newspaper	Finish the fact-check → voice-over for the video and 2 Shorts → record the UPSC corner on camera → reply to comments
Thu	UPSC: static subject	Ayush	Newspaper	Maps and visuals → start the edit
Fri	UPSC: static subject	**Channel: edit (10:00–13:00)**	Newspaper (14:30–15:00)	**15:00–18:00:** finish the edit, subtitles, thumbnail and title; schedule the video for Sat 18:00
Sat	UPSC: Mains answer	**Channel (10:00–13:00):** re-check status words in the title, cut 2 Shorts, make the UPSC note page	—	15:30–17:30 UPSC revision + PYQs · 17:30–18:00 review
Sun	**Off**	**Off**	**Off**	**Off**

Every day:

- Mon–Sat: wake at 07:00. Sunday: no alarm.
- Walk or exercise from 18:00 to 18:45.
- Eat dinner with family.
- Put the phone away by 22:30, and sleep by 23:00.

Publishing schedule. Everything is scheduled in advance, so there is no daily posting pressure.

- **Long video:** every Saturday at 18:00.
- **Shorts:** cut on Saturday, published the following week.
  - Instagram: Tuesday and Friday at 13:00.
  - YouTube: one Short on Tuesday at 13:00.
- **Instagram carousels** (posts with several swipeable images): not until February.

3.3 Mental-health rules built into the week

- **Hard stop at 18:00, Monday to Saturday.** No editing after that, not even "just 10 minutes".
- **Sunday is fully off.** No laptop and no YouTube Studio.
- **Look at numbers only at the monthly reviews**, in Weeks 4, 8 and 13. Turn off YouTube Studio and Instagram notifications on your phone. Don't open the Analytics tab when you reply to comments.
- **Diwali:** no channel work on 6–8 Nov or on Bhai Dooj (11 Nov). There is no long video on 7 Nov.

4. The production system

4.1 The pipeline: one long video + 2 Shorts a week

Main rule: "fully automated" is NOT the goal.

- YouTube does not pay channels that look mass-produced or just read out news text.
- Since July 2026, YouTube also refuses to pay channels that use an AI "persona" presented as a politics expert.
- Claude and ElevenLabs save you time. **Your judgment, your analysis and your editing make the channel original, and safe to monetize.**

#	Step	Who does it	Hours: first 3 videos → from Video 4
1	Confirm the topic (already fixed in Section 6.1) and get a source brief	Claude finds primary sources (MEA, PIB, UN, PRS, World Bank)	0.25 → 0.25
2	Read the sources	**You.** This counts as UPSC study	2 → 1.5
3	Main argument	**You**, before asking Claude for anything. Write one paragraph: what is *your* argument?	0.5 → 0.5
4	First draft	Claude writes it from your outline (~1,300–1,500 words for 10 minutes)	0.5 → 0.5
5	Rewrite	**You.** Add at least 3 points of your own analysis. Mark them [MINE] in the draft and keep them in the final script	1.5 → 1.5
6	Fact-check	Claude lists every claim in a table → **you check each one at its source**	1.5 → 1
7	Voice-over (video + 2 Short scripts)	ElevenLabs reads it in your clone voice → **you fix names and pronunciation**	1 → 0.75
8	UPSC corner	**You, on camera, in your real voice**	0.33 → 0.33
9	Maps and visuals	**You.** India_master + base maps, PIB/DD, Pexels	3 → 2
10	Edit	**You**, in Premiere or DaVinci Resolve	7 → 5
11	English subtitles	Auto-captions → **you correct them**	0.5 → 0.5
12	Title, 2 thumbnails, description, chapters	Claude gives 10–15 titles and thumbnail ideas → **you design**	1.5 → 1
13	Upload, schedule, AI label, Test & Compare	You	0.5 → 0.25
14	2 Shorts	Claude writes hook scripts (120–150 words) → **you cut them** from the same maps → you schedule them on YouTube and Instagram	3 → 1.75
15	UPSC note page	Claude drafts it from the final script → you check it	0.75 → 0.75
16	Comments	You	0.5 → 0.5
	Total		**~24 → ~18**

- The first videos take about 24 hours, which does not fit in 19. That is why Month 1 has only 2 videos and one week with no video, and why Videos 1–3 are shorter.
- From Video 4, about 18 hours fits inside your 19 hours, with a small buffer.

- **The split:** Claude does about 30–40% of the work (research, drafts, titles, notes). You do the 60–70% that makes the channel yours.

4.2 Set up a Claude Project once

Claude Free allows up to 5 Projects. Create one called "Channel" and paste in these standing instructions:

```
I make Hindi-first Hinglish geopolitics explainers for UPSC aspirants.
1. Use primary sources first (MEA, PIB, UN, PRS, World Bank/IMF, treaty texts). Always give
links.
2. Never invent a quote, number or date. If unsure, write [CHECK].
3. List every factual claim in a table: claim | source link | primary? | verified (I fill).
4. Tag every topic to the UPSC syllabus (GS2 IR a-d, GS3, GS1, Prelims places).
5. Draft only from my outline and main argument. Offer analysis as options;
   I write the final opinions myself and mark them [MINE].
6. Keep a calm, non-sensational tone. No graphic descriptions of war.
7. No "sources say" claims about Indian military operations. Use only official MEA/MoD/PIB
briefings.
8. After the final script: 2 Short scripts (120-150 words, hook first), 1 note page,
   5 MCQs and 1 Mains question.
```

What Claude does for you each week:

- The source brief and the script draft.
- The claims table and title ideas.
- The Shorts scripts, the note page and the Mains question.
- In Weeks 8–9, personalised pitch emails.

Use **NotebookLM Free** alongside Claude when you want answers based only on PDFs you upload, such as MEA briefs, PRS notes or UN reports.

4.3 Steps that always stay human

- The final topic and angle.
- Every opinion and every judgment.
- Signing off every fact against a primary source. In a 2025 EBU/BBC study, 45% of AI assistant answers about news had a significant error.
- Checking India's borders on every map, thumbnail and Short.
- Tone and wording on sensitive topics: India–Pakistan, India–China, religion.
- Any criticism of a named person or organisation, because of the risk of a defamation case.
- Making sure every title and thumbnail is honest.

4.4 Tools in the pipeline

- **Editing:** Premiere (your existing skill) or DaVinci Resolve Free. Never use your employer's software licence.
- **Shorts:** Instagram's free **Edits** app. It adds no watermark and makes automatic captions in one or two languages. CapCut is banned in India.
  - Keep something moving on screen every 3–5 seconds. Meta does not pay for static videos, image slideshows or text-only videos.
- **Maps:** your checked **India_master** file and 6 base maps (Section 5, Week 1). Animate them with your own keyframes in Premiere or After Effects.
  - For close-ups under 300 km, see the map rule in Section 10.

    - **Skip Google Earth Studio.** Its FAQ says Google does not license Earth imagery for commercial use, and its borders do not follow the Survey of India.
    - For satellite views, use Copernicus Sentinel-2 (credit: "Contains modified Copernicus Sentinel data 2026") or NASA Worldview (credit: NASA).
    - Skip paid plugins like GeoLayers for now.
- **Footage:**
    - PIB, Doordarshan and Prasar Bharati: free for creators since May 2025. The conditions are in Section 10.
    - DVIDS (US military footage): add its required disclaimer.
    - Pexels and Pixabay.
- **Music:** YouTube Audio Library only. **Use no music in Shorts.**
- **Scheduling:** YouTube Studio and Meta Business Suite (both free).

5. Month-by-month plan

Month 1 (19 Oct – 15 Nov): build and launch

Week 1 (19–25 Oct): setup. Publish nothing. (~19 hours)

☐ **Record your voice.**

- Ask Claude to turn your UPSC notes into 8–10 *conversational* GS2 explainer scripts. Make sure they include hard names: Hormuz, Malacca, Bab-el-Mandeb, Kyaukphyu, Agaléga, Jaishankar, Guterres.
- Record **60–90 minutes** of these scripts in your natural explainer style. ElevenLabs copies the style of your recordings, so don't read in a flat voice.
- Use the same mic and the same room throughout. Keep levels between −23 and −18 dB RMS, with peaks below −3 dB.
- This recording session also works as revision.

☐ **Upgrade to ElevenLabs Creator** ($22 a month). The $11 first-month price is for new Creator subscribers, so it may not apply if you took the $1 Starter plan. Train your **Professional** voice clone. You will read a short voice check with the same mic. Training takes 3–24 hours.

☐ **Create the YouTube channel and an Instagram professional account** with the same name. Put your real name in the About section.

☐ **In YouTube Studio:**

- Verify your phone number. You need this for custom thumbnails and for uploads over 15 minutes.
- Complete ID or video verification to turn on **advanced features**. You need these for Test & Compare.
- Turn on **2-Step Verification**.

☐ **Record your 8–10 second on-camera intro** in your real voice. For example: *"Main [Name], UPSC aspirant aur video editor. Is video ka narration meri apni awaaz ka AI clone hai."* Reuse it in every video.

☐ **Make India_master** (see Section 10). Export the first 2 base maps in 4K: West Asia and Indian Ocean. Make the other 4 (World, South Asia, East Asia, Europe) when a video needs them.

☐ **Build a template kit:** map style, name strips (lower-thirds), caption preset, end screen and thumbnail template.

☐ **Set up the Claude Project.** Use any hours left over for steps 1–3 of Video 1.

Week 2 (26 Oct – 1 Nov): Video 1 (Hormuz, 8–10 min) goes out on Sat 31 Oct. No Shorts this week.

☐ **Wed 28 Oct: test whether the voice clone is good enough.**

- Generate 2 minutes of Video 1.
- If it needs more than about 5 fixes per minute, or sounds flat, record Video 1 in your real voice. This takes about 1–1.5 hours. Improve the clone later.

☐ Before publishing, check whether Hormuz is still closed. If it has reopened, use the backup title (Section 6.1).

☐ **Decide your UPSC path by Sat 31 Oct** (Section 7.4). Write it on page 1 of your notebook.

Week 3 (2–8 Nov): no long video. US midterms on Tue 3 Nov; Diwali from 6 Nov.

☐ Mon–Tue: cut 3 Shorts from Video 1's maps. Schedule 1 for this week and 2 for next week.

☐ Wed–Thu (4–5 Nov), after the election results: read sources and outline Video 2.

☐ 6–8 Nov: no channel work. Enjoy Diwali.

Week 4 (9–15 Nov): Video 2 (US midterms + Jaishankar "reset", 8–10 min) goes out on Sat 14 Nov.

☐ Final election results can take days or weeks. Show "Results as of [date]" on screen.

☐ Bhai Dooj (Wed 11 Nov): no channel work.

☐ Saturday: cut 2 Shorts from Video 2 for next week.

☐ **Do your first monthly review** (Section 9.1).

Month 1 deliverables: 2 long videos · 3 Shorts · 2 UPSC note pages · a trained voice clone · a template kit · India_master + 2 base maps · your chosen UPSC path.

Month 2 (16 Nov – 13 Dec): find your rhythm

Every week: 1 long video (Saturday) + 2 Shorts + 1 note page + 1 Mains answer.

☐ **Week 5:** Turn on **Test & Compare** with 2 thumbnails for every long video. Video 3 is the last 8–10 minute video.

☐ **Week 6 (optional):** Take **one** small editing client, at most 3 hours a week. Do this only if all three rules in Section 8.2 are met. In any week you work for the client, make 1 Short.

☐ **Week 7:** Ask Ayush's team, politely, about work after mid-January.

☐ **Week 8:** Send about 8 freelance pitches (Section 8.2). Make only 1 Short this Saturday so the pitches fit.

☐ **Week 8:** Time your whole pipeline. Does it fit in 19 hours? Do the monthly review and look at your UPSC path again.

Month 2 deliverables: 4 long videos · 8 Shorts · 4 note pages · 4 Mains answers.

Month 3 (14 Dec – 17 Jan): prove it works

Every week: 1 long video + 2 Shorts. Make only 1 Short in Weeks 9 and 11.

☐ **Week 9:**

- Send about 7 more pitches, for 15 in total. Expect 1–3 replies (est.). Make 1 Short.
- Start a free **Telegram channel** and post your note pages there. Share only your own notes, never coaching PDFs.
- Outline the year-recap video, using your note pages and existing maps.

☐ **Week 10 (21–27 Dec):** Video 8 (India–EU FTA) goes out on Sat 26 Dec. Before publishing, check whether the deal was actually signed.

☐ **Week 11 (28 Dec – 3 Jan):**

- The year recap goes out on Sat 2 Jan: 15–18 minutes, 10 events, with "Events till 20 Dec 2026" on screen.
- Reuse earlier claims tables and maps. Make 1 Short.

☐ **By 1 Jan:** if February work is not confirmed (a renewal or a client), take any paid editing work for January and February.

☐ **Week 12 (4–10 Jan):** Video 10 (diaspora) goes out on Sat 9 Jan.

☐ **Week 13 (11–17 Jan):**

- The CSE 2027 notification comes out on Wed 13 Jan. Read the PDF on the official UPSC website.
- Video 11 goes out on Sat 16 Jan.
- Do the **decision review** on Saturday 15:30–17:30, instead of revision (Section 9.2).

Weeks 10–11 cover Christmas and New Year. If you want a break, use the missed-week rule.

Month 3 deliverables: 5 long videos (including the year recap) · 7 Shorts · 5 note pages · a Telegram channel · 15 pitches sent · your decisions for February.

Process targets: fully in your control, and they matter most

☐ 11 long videos and about 18 Shorts, on schedule. Using the missed-week rule is allowed.

☐ A pipeline that fits in 19 hours a week by Week 8.

☐ 11 UPSC note pages and about 12 handwritten Mains answers.

☐ Sunday off and the 18:00 stop kept in most weeks.

Outcome numbers such as subscribers and views depend partly on luck. They are in Section 9.2, and you look at them only at the monthly reviews.

6. Topics

6.1 The 11 long videos

Tags used below:

- ★ means the topic matches a 2026 UPSC GS2 Mains question.
- The GS2 IR syllabus has 4 parts: (a) India's neighbourhood, (b) groupings and agreements, (c) other countries' policies and the diaspora, (d) international institutions.

#	Publish (Sat 18:00)	Working title	UPSC tag	Why now
1	31 Oct	Hormuz band, phir bhi India ka tel kahan se aaya? *(backup: "Hormuz sankat: India ka tel kahan se aa raha hai?")*	GS2(c), GS3 energy, Prelims map	The biggest live story. The strait had been closed for more than 220 days as of 12 Oct
–	7 Nov	*No long video (Diwali week)*		
2	14 Nov	US chunav ke baad: Jaishankar ka "reset" India ke liye kya matlab?	GS2(c), diaspora	US midterms on 3 Nov; Jaishankar's "reset" remark on 13 Oct
3	21 Nov	BRI ne South Asia ko battlefield kaise banaya	GS2(a)(c) ★Q20	A direct PYQ
4	28 Nov	COP31 Antalya: climate finance, CBAM aur India	GS3 environment, GS2(d)	COP31 ends on 20 Nov
5	5 Dec	Siliguri "Chicken's Neck" aur naya Bangladesh	GS2(a), GS3 security, GS1	"Bangladesh" is a high-click keyword. This needs a close-up map, so follow the rule in Section 10
6	12 Dec	Quad + IPMDA + SAGAR: Indian Ocean mein India ka game	GS2(b) ★Q9	A direct PYQ
7	19 Dec	G20 Miami bina South Africa: kya G20 toot raha hai?	GS2(b)(d)	The summit is on 14–15 Dec
8	26 Dec	India–EU FTA: "Mother of all deals", kisko fayda?	GS2(b), GS3 economy	The signing is targeted for December
9	2 Jan	2026 ka geopolitics: UPSC 2027 ke liye 10 events (15–18 min)	All of GS2-IR, Prelims	A year recap built from your own notes and maps
10	9 Jan	Diaspora "living bridge": remittance se soft power tak	GS2(c) ★Q19	Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, Kolkata, 7–9 Jan
11	16 Jan	UPSC GS2 2026 ke 4 IR sawaal, 4 kahaniyan	All of GS2-IR ★	3 days after the CSE 2027 notification

Backup topics (use one if a video has to change):

1. **Duniya ke 7 chokepoints: India ki nas.** This is the emergency video: evergreen, and it reuses the Hormuz maps.
2. Indus Waters Treaty "in abeyance"
3. Pakistan vs Taliban (the Durand Line)
4. Chabahar after the US sanctions waiver ended
5. India–China "new elevation"
6. Greenland and the Arctic
7. Venezuela after Maduro
8. India in Africa
9. The UN Secretary-General race

Breaking-news rule:

- Switch topics only if the event is one of the top 3 national stories **and** India has a clear stake in it. Otherwise, make a Short about it.
- If you switch, the planned topic moves one week later, and the last topic is dropped.
- If the news is a military flare-up involving India, follow the rule in Section 10.
- Cover war calmly, with maps, and with no graphic footage.

6.2 The 18 Shorts (35–60 seconds each)

Formats:

- **Map:** one map, one minute.
- **News → India:** what a news event means for India.
- **PYQ in 60 sec:** one exam question and its answer outline.
- **Places in News:** places to know for Prelims.
- **Explainer.**

Every Short is cut from that week's long video. The one exception is the monthly **Places in News** Short. You collect those places during your Saturday UPSC revision, so making it is also Prelims prep. The first Short listed for each week also goes on YouTube.

#	Goes out	Short	Cut from	Format	UPSC tag
1	Week 3	Strait of Hormuz: 1 map, 1 minute	Video 1	Map	GS1, Prelims
2	Week 4	Russian oil record (~2.7 mbpd, Jun 2026): majboori ya strategy?	Video 1	News → India	GS2(c), GS3
3	Week 4	India ke strategic oil reserves: 3 jagah, 1 map	Video 1	Map	GS3, Prelims
4	Week 5	Jaishankar: US ne "deliberately" khud ko "lonelier power" banaya. Matlab?	Video 2	News → India	GS2(c)
5	Week 5	US chunav: H-1B aur tariffs pe kya asar?	Video 2	News → India	GS2(c), diaspora
6	Week 6	Gwadar, Hambantota, Kyaukphyu: 3 ports, 1 map	Video 3	Map	GS2(a), Prelims
7	Week 6	PYQ in 60 sec: GS2 2026 Q20 (BRI)	Video 3	PYQ	GS2(a)
8	Week 7	CBAM in 60 seconds	Video 4	Explainer	GS3
9	Week 7	Places in News: November 2026	Sat revision	Places	Prelims
10	Week 8	Siliguri Corridor on the map	Video 5	Map	GS2(a), GS3
11	Week 8	Teesta dispute in 60 seconds	Video 5	Explainer	GS2(a), GS1
12	Week 9	IPMDA kya hai?	Video 6	Explainer	GS2(b) ★Q9
13	Week 10	G7 vs G20 vs BRICS vs SCO in 60 seconds	Video 7	Explainer	GS2(b)
14	Week 11	India–EU FTA: 3 winners, 3 worries	Video 8	News → India	GS2(b), GS3
15	Week 11	Places in News: December 2026	Sat revision	Places	Prelims
16	Week 12	BRICS New Delhi Declaration: 3 takeaways	Video 9	Explainer	GS2(b) ★Q10
17	Week 13	Remittances: India duniya mein No. 1. Matlab?	Video 10	Explainer	GS2(c), GS3
18	Week 13	PYQ in 60 sec: GS2 2026 Q19 (diaspora)	Video 10	PYQ	GS2(c)

Spare Shorts (use one if a Short doesn't work, or in February):

- Malacca Dilemma kya hai?
- Bab-el-Mandeb + Red Sea
- "Debt trap": myth vs fact
- COP31: host Türkiye, talks led by Australia
- Diego Garcia, Djibouti, Agaléga on the map
- Indus Waters Treaty: 6 rivers, 1 map
- UN Secretary-General kaise chuna jata hai?
- Pravasi Bharatiya Divas 9 Jan ko hi kyun?
- UPSC CSE 2027 key dates (only after you read the official notification)

Every fact in these titles still goes through the claims table before you publish.

7. UPSC integration

7.1 Every video becomes revision

After you finish each script, ask Claude to make the items below. The "upsc-gs-answer-writer" and "upsc-topic-revision" skills help with this.

Output	What it contains	Your job
1 note page	Syllabus code, background, 5 key facts with sources, India's interests, way forward, 5 keywords	Check it and add one line in your own words
1 map	The video's main map	Redraw it once by hand, from memory
1 Mains question	Written in PYQ style	Answer it by hand on an odd-week Saturday (see 7.2)
5 MCQs (optional)	Built from the video's facts	Real PYQs matter more

Store your notes by syllabus code: GS2-IR (a), (b), (c), (d) · GS3 · GS1 · Prelims places.

Revision rhythm (1–7–30): revise each note page on day 1, day 7 and day 30. Do this in the Saturday revision block.

Teaching is learning. Writing a script forces you to really understand a topic. This is the strongest link between your channel and your UPSC prep.

7.2 What the channel does not cover

The channel covers international relations plus some geography, economy and environment. That is maybe 10–15% of the syllabus (est.). In the 2026 GS2 paper, IR questions were worth 50 of 250 marks. **Polity, economy, history, geography, environment, science and technology, and CSAT still need separate study.**

- **Mornings (07:30–08:30, Mon–Fri):** study one static subject at a time. Polity in Oct–Nov, Economy in Dec–Jan. Continue from where your earlier prep stopped.
- **Saturday 15:30–16:30:** revise the note pages that are due (1–7–30).
- **Saturday 16:30–17:30:** solve 25 real Prelims PYQs from this month's static subject.
- **Saturday 07:30–08:30:** write one Mains answer by hand, 150–250 words.
  - Odd weeks: the video's IR question.
  - Even weeks: a real GS2 Polity PYQ (Oct–Nov) or GS3 Economy PYQ (Dec–Jan).
  - Then compare your answer with a model answer.

7.3 Minimum routine for busy weeks: 45 minutes a day

- 20 min: one newspaper editorial or the international page.
- 15 min: revise one note page.
- 10 min: solve 5 PYQs or MCQs.

On a bad day, 15 minutes counts. A missed day is fine; start again tomorrow.

7.4 CSE 2027 and your path

Date	Event
13 Jan 2027	Notification (the Wednesday of your last week)
2 Feb 2027	Last date to apply

Date	Event
23 May 2027	Prelims (Sunday)
20 Aug 2027	Mains begins

Decide by 31 Oct, and write your answer on page 1 of your notebook:

- **Path A: a foundation year (fits this plan).** UPSC study stays at 10.5 hours a week. Your serious target is CSE 2028.
- **Path B: a serious 2027 attempt.**
  - From Week 5, publish 1 long video every 2 weeks (every other topic in 6.1) and 1 Short a week. Channel work drops to about 9 hours a week.
  - UPSC study rises to about 20 hours a week, using the freed time.
  - From February you will need 35+ hours a week (est.). That means not renewing the 16-hour contract, or cutting it to 2 days a week.
- Look at this choice again only at the Week 8 review.

About attempts:

- Applying alone does not use an attempt.
- Sitting any Prelims paper does use one. General and EWS candidates get 6 attempts; OBC candidates get 9.
- If you are not ready, **don't sit Prelims 2027**. On 23 May, solve the real paper at home with a 2-hour timer instead. Coaching sites post the paper within hours.

8. Money plan

8.1 What your hours earn now (est.)

Work	Roughly ₹ per hour
Ayush contract	~₹580 (₹40k ÷ about 69 hours a month)
Freelance editing	~₹500–1,000
Your channel	~₹0 for the next 12+ months. It is an investment, not a wage

Use these numbers when you decide where a spare hour goes.

8.2 Income streams, in the order they can start

#	Stream	When it can start	Likely in these 3 months	Later potential
1	Ayush/Khabargaon contract	Now	₹40k/month	Ask about renewal in Week 7
2	Freelance video editing	One small client from Month 2 (optional); a retainer from February	₹0–10k	A retainer of ₹15–28k (junior level) to ₹30–58k (mid-level). About ₹4k–8k per long video and ₹800–2,500 per Short (est.)
3	Premium map-animation editing for other channels	Once your own videos can serve as a portfolio	₹0	₹5k–25k+ per advanced video
4	A paid geopolitics explainer segment for Khabargaon	Pitch it any time	Maybe	Depends on them. It also solves any contract conflict
5	Telegram channel	Week 9	₹0. It is a free way to keep fans close	Ad share starts at 1,000 subscribers. It pays little, and in TON crypto, which is taxed at 30% + 1% TDS
6	Paid PDF on Topmate (Topmate keeps 10%)	February	—	Sell it at ₹149, with content you have *not* posted free: 25 annotated India-map pages, 60 PYQ-linked MCQs, and a one-page Mains framework per topic. Base: 0–15 copies (₹0–2,000 after Topmate's cut). Good: 15–50 copies (₹2,000–6,700)
7	Affiliate links (Amazon pays 4.72% on books; Instagram product tags)	At about 1,000 engaged followers, probably after this plan	₹0	₹0–1k/month until you have 20k+ followers. Amazon may close accounts that make too few sales in the first months, so check the A mazon.in terms first
8	Instagram Gifts (from 500 followers) and Creator Marketplace (from 1,000 followers; brings brand deals)	When you reach those numbers. In the base case you may not	₹0–500	Small
9	Small paid Reels, or barter (a product instead of money)	Only in the good scenario	₹1k–3k each	The middle price is ~₹4,750 per Reel for accounts with 10k–50k followers
10	YouTube fan funding, then YouTube Shopping	At 500 subs + 3,000 watch hours	Unlikely	₹0–2,000/month at first (est.)
11	Ed-tech or app sponsors (e.g. Vision IAS, PW OnlyIAS, Testbook, Kuku FM)	Start pitching at ~5k subs if your average views are 3k+. Expect the first yes around 10k	No	About 1 deal every 1–3 months, ₹10k–20k each

#	Stream	When it can start	Likely in these 3 months	Later potential
12	YouTube ads	At 1,000 subs + 8,000 watch hours (the rule from 1 Feb 2027)	No	₹10k–30k/month in the good case (est.)

Take a freelance client in Months 2–3 only if all three are true:

1. Your contract allows it.
2. You slept 7+ hours on most nights in Month 1.
3. Videos 1 and 2 went out on time.

The work is capped at 3 hours a week, and in any week you work for the client, you make only 1 Short.

Pitch plan (to protect your February income):

- Week 7: ask Ayush's team about renewal.
- Weeks 8–9: send 15 short pitches to UPSC educators and small ed-tech or news YouTubers.
  - Use your work with Ayush and your 2–3 best videos as your portfolio.
  - Claude can personalise one template for each person.
  - Expect 1–3 replies (est.).
- If nothing is confirmed by 1 Jan, take any paid editing work for January and February.

Never accept these sponsors:

- Real-money gaming apps. Promoting them has been illegal since Aug 2025.
- Trading or broker apps, because of SEBI rules.
- Anyone selling pirated PDFs.

8.3 The money ladder

Each step is reachable, and each one shows progress before the big number.

Step	When (est.)
1. Your first rupee outside the contract (an editing job)	Month 2–3 or February
2. YouTube fan-funding tier (500 subs + 3,000 hours)	4–12 months
3. Your first ₹10–20k sponsor	Around 10k subscribers
4. YouTube ads tier (1,000 subs + 8,000 hours)	Good case: 6–12 months. Base case: 12–24+ months
5. Your first ₹25k month from content	12–18 months, good case
6. ₹1.1 lakh a month in total income	18–24 months, good case

8.4 What ₹1.1 lakh total income could look like in 18–24 months (good case, est.)

Source	Per month
YouTube ads	₹10k–30k
Ed-tech or app sponsorship (about 1 deal every 1–3 months at 10–25k subs)	₹5k–15k
Instagram deals + affiliate links (the top of the range needs 25–50k followers)	₹10k–40k
Notes, PDFs and Telegram (there is a lot of free competition; Vision IAS gives away IR PYQs free)	₹3k–10k
Content only	**₹28k–95k**
Freelance editing (1 retainer)	₹20k–40k

Source	Per month
Total	**₹48k–1.35 lakh**

8.5 Monthly cash flow (fill in the blanks)

	Per month
In: contract	₹40,000. Khabargaon may deduct TDS, often 10% on professional fees. If so, you receive about ₹36,000 and can claim the rest back in your tax return. Your yearly income is probably below the no-tax limit; confirm this with a CA
Out: tools	₹2,600–5,400 (Section 8.6)
Out: family	₹____
Out: fixed savings (transfer on payday)	₹____

Keep a simple sheet of every rupee you spend and earn from day 1. You will need it for tax later.

8.6 Tool budget

Tool	Plan	₹ per month	Notes
ElevenLabs	Creator	~₹2,600 (first month ₹1,300–2,600)	Paid by card in USD. UPI is not accepted. Optional $1 Starter test this week (~₹120)
Claude	**Start on Free** (+ NotebookLM Free)	₹0	Upgrade to Pro (₹2,399/month, billed monthly) only if you hit the usage limits twice in one week. Don't take the annual plan in these 3 months
Premiere	Annual plan, first-year price	₹389	Cancelling an annual plan early may cost a fee. DaVinci Resolve Free costs ₹0
Maps, Shorts editing, footage, scheduling	QGIS, Natural Earth, Edits, Pexels, Pixabay, PIB/DD, YouTube Studio, Meta Business Suite	₹0	Buy paid stock footage only after Month 2, and only if free sources really limit you
Mic	One-time purchase	₹2,000–2,500	
Monthly total		**~₹2,600–3,000** (with Claude Pro: ~₹5,000–5,400)	
All 3 months, including the mic		**~₹8,500–11,500** (with Claude Pro: ~₹16,000–19,000)	

Starting on Claude Free saves about ₹7,200 over 3 months. That is about 18% of one month's contract pay.

9. Reviews and the decision point

9.1 Weekly review (Saturday 17:30–18:00)

Write down 3 things:

1. Long video published: yes/no. Shorts: __/2.
2. UPSC hours: __/10.5. Mains answer written: yes/no.
3. Energy level: 1 to 5.

Then answer two questions, one line each:

- What worked this week?
- What **one** thing will I change next week?

If your energy is 2 or lower for two weeks in a row: next week, make 1 Short and no long video. Talk to someone you trust, or call Tele-MANAS on 14416.

Monthly review: on the Saturdays of Weeks 4, 8 and 13. Start at 17:15 that day, because it takes 20 extra minutes. This is the only time you open analytics. Write these down, with no targets:

- The CTR of each long video. For a new channel, 3–5% is normal and 5% or more is good.
- The average % of each long video that people watched.
- New subscribers and total watch hours.
- Instagram followers.
- Pipeline time: does it fit in 19 hours?
- Are the views per long video going up? If yes, you may start posting both Shorts on YouTube.

Compare yourself only with **your own** last month, never with Dhruv Rathee or Gaurav Thakur. They have years of videos behind them.

9.2 Decision point (Week 13: Saturday 16 Jan, 15:30–17:30)

Scenario (odds, est.)	Subscribers by mid-Jan	Watch hours	Instagram followers*	Next step
Great (≤5–10%)	10,000+	4,000+	5,000–15,000	You should already have applied for YPP on the day you reached 1,000 subs + 4,000 hours. Keep the schedule and start pitching sponsors
Good (~20–30%)	1,000–5,000	1,500–4,000	500–4,000	Keep the same schedule. Pitch ed-tech sponsors at ~5k subs if your average views are 3k+
Base (~60–70%)	200–1,000	100–1,000	50–300	Normal for month 3. Continue for 6 more months on the same schedule. This is the most common path
Below base, but you enjoy the work				A packaging problem. Change titles, thumbnails or topics. Study your best video and make 3 more like it
Below base, and you hate the process				A format problem. Change the format: more Shorts, more of your face, or editing services for others. Don't quit everything

*Instagram estimate: about 18 Reels × typical views per Reel × a 0.3–1% chance that a viewer follows you.

Also decide that week:

- ☐ CSE 2027: apply by 2 Feb to keep the option open? Sit Prelims only if you chose Path B and feel ready.
- ☐ Income from February: a contract renewal, a freelance retainer, or both? Launch the ₹149 Topmate PDF?
- ☐ Does my pipeline fit in 19 hours a week? If not, what will I drop?
- ☐ Add Instagram carousels from February? Only if there are spare hours.

10. Risks and rules

Risk	Rule
Copyright strikes (3 strikes in 90 days and YouTube deletes the channel)	• Never use ANI or private TV news clips, not even a few seconds. • Never use a clip or photo with an ANI, PTI, IANS, Reuters, AP or Getty mark or credit, even if a government account posted it. • Download PIB/DD content only from pib.gov.in, PBShabd or DD's official channels. Use it accurately, never in a mocking way, and always credit it. • Log each file: date, URL and a screenshot of the licence. • DVIDS: add its required disclaimer. • Music only from the YouTube Audio Library, and no music in Shorts.
A wrong map of India (publishing a map that differs from the Survey of India's can mean up to 6 months in jail and/or a fine; cases are rare and need a government complaint, but take this seriously)	• Load `ne_10m_admin_0_countries_ind` (v5.1.1). • Check it against the Survey of India political map: Gilgit-Baltistan, PoK, Aksai Chin, Shaksgam, Arunachal, Kalapani–Lipulekh and Sir Creek. Also check that Andaman & Nicobar and Lakshadweep are shown. • Save it as **India_master**. Use it in every frame that shows any part of India: videos, thumbnails, Shorts and PDFs. • For close-ups under 300 km, use OpenStreetMap data for undisputed borders, with the credit "© OpenStreetMap contributors". • In disputed areas, keep India_master as the outer line. Draw the LoC/LAC only as labelled dashed lines inside it, and show "Boundaries approximate" on screen. • Use the Survey of India map only for checking. Don't paste it into videos. • Never use Wikimedia or foreign maps without this check.
Thumbnail faces	Use only these sources: • PIB photos, never next to mocking or alarmist words. • US government photos (public domain). • Photos from the Kremlin's official site (CC BY 4.0, with credit). • Wikimedia files whose licence you have checked.
AI voice disclosure	YouTube does not require a label when you clone your own voice. But India's 2026 IT Rules require synthetic content to be labelled, and Meta requires a label on realistic AI audio. So, on every upload with clone narration: 1. In YouTube Studio, answer **Yes** to the AI/synthetic content question. Expect a visible label on news videos. YouTube says disclosure does not reduce reach or earnings. 2. On Instagram, turn on the AI label for every Reel. 3. Add this line to every description: *"Narration: AI clone of my own voice (ElevenLabs). Script drafted with AI help (Claude), rewritten and fact-checked by me."* 4. Your on-camera intro says the same thing in your real voice. Never use realistic AI footage of real leaders or real attacks.
ElevenLabs Free plan	Never publish audio made on the Free plan. It can never be used commercially, even after you upgrade
YouTube's "AI persona" and "inauthentic content" rules	• Put your real name in the About section. • Show your face and real voice in the intro and the UPSC corner. • Include at least 3 [MINE] points in every script. • Never just read out news text. • Never use an AI avatar as the host.

Risk	Rule
Misuse of your voice	Don't share your clone in ElevenLabs' public Voice Library. Anyone could then make content in the voice your audience trusts
Fact errors and defamation	• Make a claims table for every video and sign it off against primary sources. • Never use an AI-invented quote. • Choose words carefully when you criticise a named person or company. In 2025, the Delhi High Court ordered a well-known YouTuber to remove parts of a video it found defamatory to ANI.
Military flare-ups involving India	• No real-time or "sources say" claims about military operations, troop or ship movements, or casualties. • Cite only MEA, MoD or PIB briefings, and publish at least 24 hours after an official briefing. • Maps show only what officials have released. • The government warned channels and individuals about this in April 2025, and a YouTube news channel was blocked on national-security grounds.
Misleading titles (YouTube enforces this on news content in India first)	The title and thumbnail must match what the video delivers. Re-check status words within 24 hours before publishing
War content	Keep it calm, non-graphic and analytical. Don't stuff tragedy keywords into titles. Some conflict videos may get limited or no ads while YouTube treats the event as sensitive
Burnout	Stop at 18:00. Keep Sunday off. Cut Shorts before you cut sleep. Follow the energy rule (9.1)
An income gap after mid-January	Ask about renewal in Week 7. Send 15 pitches in Weeks 8–9. If nothing is confirmed by 1 Jan, take any paid editing work. If you can, save 2–3 months of expenses
A conflict with your contract	Complete Section 0 before you launch. Never use Khabargaon's footage, brand, music or software licence
Abusive comments	Turn on filters for abusive words. Don't argue. If needed, pin one calm reply with a source

11. When you start overthinking

1. **Decide once.** The week's topic is already fixed in Section 6.1. Confirm it on Monday at 15:30, in 5 minutes. Only the breaking-news rule can change it.
2. **Use a "good enough" checklist, then publish.** Once the facts are checked, the map borders are correct, the audio is clean and the title is honest, you publish. Any extra improvement goes into the next video. Make at most 2 thumbnail versions and let Test & Compare decide.
3. **Look at numbers only at the monthly review.** When you feel the urge to check stats, open the next task in the pipeline instead. One video's views tell you almost nothing; eleven videos tell you a lot.
4. **Write it down, then work for 25 minutes.** When worries pile up (money, family, UPSC, the future), write them on paper for 5 minutes. Then pick the smallest next task and work on it for 25 minutes. Doing something reduces overthinking; more thinking does not.

Your family needs you healthy more than they need a fast-growing channel. If stress starts hurting your sleep or health, talk to a doctor or counsellor. India's free mental-health helpline, **Tele-MANAS**, is **14416**. It is open 24×7 and works in many languages. Asking for help is a strong move, not a weak one.

Remember: an empire is built from boring, repeated weeks. Your job for the next 13 weeks is simple: **one honest video a week, two Shorts, one UPSC page, and enough sleep.**

Appendix: the money math (read once)

A.1 ₹60,000 a month from long videos

A Hindi or Hinglish channel with mostly Indian viewers earns about **₹20–₹50 RPM**. If advertisers treat it as exam education, it may reach ₹50–₹100 (est.).

Your RPM	Views needed per month	Views needed per day
₹20	30 lakh	~1 lakh
₹35	17 lakh	~57,000
₹50	12 lakh	~40,000
₹80 (if the UPSC framing works)	7.5 lakh	~25,000

- **Plan with the ₹20–35 rows.** ₹50–100 needs exam-prep advertisers to bid on your videos, and nobody has shown that they do for this niche yet.
- Some conflict videos may get limited or no ads while YouTube treats the event as sensitive.
- Channels that get 7–30 lakh views a month usually have tens of thousands to 1 lakh+ subscribers and 50–100+ videos. By January you will have 11 videos.

A.2 ₹50,000 a month from Shorts and Instagram

YouTube Shorts pay very little in India. Expect about ₹1–₹5 per 1,000 engaged views, maybe up to ₹10 (est.). An engaged view is one where the viewer stayed past the first seconds. One Indian creator reported earning about ₹0.9 per 1,000.

Shorts RPM	Views needed per month	Views needed per day
₹1	5 crore	16.7 lakh
₹2	2.5 crore	8.3 lakh
₹5	1 crore	3.3 lakh
₹10	50 lakh	1.7 lakh

- All your Shorts together will probably get under 5 lakh views in 3 months. That is less than what a single day of the ₹50k target needs.
- Since Aug 2026, the public view count includes every play, but only *engaged* views pay. So the number you see will be higher than the number that earns.

Instagram pays ₹0 per view in India. There is no Reels revenue share, and the Reels bonus is closed to Indian creators. Money on Instagram comes only from brand deals, affiliate links and small "Gifts".

- ₹50k a month needs about **25,000–50,000 engaged followers**. That takes 9–18 months if growth goes well (est.).
- At the typical price of ₹4,750 per Reel, even 6–10 deals a month make only ₹28k–48k. That many deals would also turn half your feed into ads.
- A realistic ₹50k mix at that size:
  - 3–4 deals a month at ₹6–10k each (₹18–40k), each sold as a Reel + YouTube Short package.
  - Plus affiliate and PDF income (₹5–10k).

A.3 The YouTube rule change on 1 Feb 2027

	Until 31 Jan 2027	From 1 Feb 2027
Join YPP for ad money	1,000 subs + 4,000 watch hours in 12 months, or 10M Shorts views in 90 days	1,000 subs + **8,000** watch hours, or **20M** Shorts views
Earn from Shorts	You must already be in the YPP ads tier; no extra view minimum	You also need 10M Shorts views every 90 days
Fan-funding tier (memberships, Super Thanks, Shopping)	500 subs + 3,000 watch hours, or 3M Shorts views	**Unchanged**

At 5 minutes of average watch time, 4,000 hours is about 48,000 views, and 8,000 hours is about 1 lakh views. Only public long videos count; Shorts watch time does not.

Sources

YouTube rules and money

- YPP changes from 1 Feb 2027 (YouTube Blog, 10 Aug 2026): https://blog.youtube/news-and-events/youtube-partner-program-updates-2027-new-opportunities-earn/
- Qualified watch hours and Shorts views: https://blog.youtube/news-and-events/youtube-monetization-qualified-watch-hours-shorts-views/
- YPP tiers: https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/13429240
- Shorts monetization: https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/12504220
- Monetization policies (inauthentic and reused content): https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/1311392
- AI persona rule (Tubefilter, 13 Jul 2026): https://www.tubefilter.com/2026/07/13/youtube-inauthentic-content-monetization-policy-update/
- AI disclosure: https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/14328491
- Policy changelog (India misleading-title enforcement): https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/10008196
- Advertiser-friendly guidelines (sensitive events): https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/6162278
- Old-rule uncertainty (vidIQ): https://vidiq.com/blog/post/youtube-partner-program-changes-2027/
- Copyright strikes: https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/2814000

Growth and RPM data

- AIR Media-Tech RPM study: https://air.io/en/air-data-findings/how-much-does-youtube-really-pay-in-2026-real-rpm-data-from-300-channels
- MilX timelines and upload studies: https://milx.app/en/cases/how-long-does-it-take-to-start-making-money-on-youtube
- upGrowth India CPM/RPM: https://upgrowth.in/youtube-cpm-india-guide-2026/
- Indian Shorts earnings thread: https://www.reddit.com/r/YouTubeCreators/comments/1qgxzjf/24m_shorts_views_but_only_133_revenue_is_shorts/
- "Crack UPSC With Me" income estimate: https://sponsorradar.com/channels/crackupsc-25
- Swarajya on the niche: https://swarajyamag.com/commentary/why-millions-of-indians-are-obsessed-with-defence-and-geopolitics-content

Instagram and other income

- Instagram Gifts: https://help.instagram.com/738469380549477
- Creator Marketplace: https://help.instagram.com/1389278101788752
- Instagram monetization policies: https://help.instagram.com/2635536099905516
- Reel rates in India: https://influencermetric.in/blog/instagram-collaboration-rates-india
- YouTube Shopping at 500 subscribers: https://www.storyboard18.com/digital/youtube-opens-shopping-affiliate-program-to-creators-with-500-subscribers-93649.htm
- Editing rates: https://fueler.io/blog/video-editor-salary-in-india-freelance-and-full-time-pay-guide
- Topmate pricing: https://topmate.io/pricing
- Amazon.in fees: https://affiliate-program.amazon.in/help/node/topic/GRXPHT8U84RAYDXZ
- Telegram monetization: https://telegram.org/blog/monetization-for-channels
- Vision IAS free IR PYQs: https://cdn.visionias.in/value_added_material/a7a53-international-relations.pdf
- Real-money gaming ad ban: https://www.storyboard18.com/advertising/online-gaming-bill-puts-creator-earnings-from-rmg-in-flux-25-30-ad-spends-to-shift-to-esports-casual-gaming-79281.htm

- IT Rules labelling of synthetic content: https://www.exchange4media.com/digital-news/new-rule-mandates-clear-labelling-of-synthetic-content-on-digital-platforms-151874.html

Tools, maps and footage

- ElevenLabs pricing: https://elevenlabs.io/pricing
- Professional voice cloning: https://elevenlabs.io/docs/eleven-creative/voices/voice-cloning/professional-voice-cloning
- Free-plan commercial use: https://help.elevenlabs.io/hc/en-us/articles/13313564601361-Can-I-publish-the-content-I-generate-on-the-platform
- Claude pricing: https://claude.com/pricing
- Premiere India plans: https://www.adobe.com/in/products/premiere/plans.html
- EBU/BBC AI accuracy study: https://www.bbc.co.uk/mediacentre/2025/new-ebu-research-ai-assistants-news-content
- Map law (Criminal Law Amendment Act s.2): https://indiankanoon.org/doc/496978/
- Natural Earth (India POV file): https://www.naturalearthdata.com/downloads/10m-cultural-vectors/
- OpenStreetMap attribution: https://osmfoundation.org/wiki/Licence/Attribution_Guidelines
- Google Earth Studio FAQ: https://www.google.com/earth/studio/faq/
- PIB copyright policy: https://www.pib.gov.in/content/102_2_Copyright-Policy.aspx
- Free government content for creators: https://www.storyboard18.com/how-it-works/amid-ani-controversy-govt-broadcasters-make-content-free-or-affordable-for-creators-68075.htm
- DVIDS copyright: https://www.dvidshub.net/about/copyright
- ANI and fair dealing: https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/explained-law/ani-youtube-copyright-10061049/
- Delhi HC defamation order: https://www.thenewsminute.com/news/ani-vs-mohak-mangal-delhi-hc-orders-youtuber-to-remove-defamatory-content-from-video

UPSC and current affairs

- CSE 2027 dates: https://www.amarujala.com/jobs/government-jobs/upsc-cse-2027-dates-announced-prelims-on-may-23-mains-on-20-aug-official-notification-to-release-on-jan-13-2026-05-20
- CSE 2027 calendar (VisionIAS): https://visionias.in/blog/upsc-news/upsc-calendar-2027-out-cse-prelims-on-23-may-2027-check-exam-dates-download-pdf
- GS2 2026 paper: https://anantamias.com/upsc-mains-2026-gs-paper-2-question-paper/
- Hormuz timeline: https://hormuzstraitmonitor.com/crisis-timeline/
- Russian oil record: https://www.intellinews.com/india-s-russian-crude-imports-hit-record-level-450493/
- Jaishankar "reset": https://m.economictimes.com/news/india/jaishankar-countries-must-reset-relations-with-the-us-amid-changing-global-engagement/articleshow/134921503.cms
- Jaishankar "lonelier power": https://www.thestatesman.com/world/us-has-deliberately-become-a-lonelier-power-jaishankar-flags-chinas-rise-at-munich-leaders-meeting-1503646884.html
- COP31: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2026_United_Nations_Climate_Change_Conference
- G20 Miami: https://www.thestatesman.com/world/us-drops-south-africa-from-2026-g20-invites-poland-to-join-1503521836.html
- India–EU FTA signing: https://www.steelorbis.com/steel-news/latest-news/india-eu-fta-to-be-signed-in-dec-2026-to-take-effect-from-feb-mar-2027-1460720.htm
- Pravasi Bharatiya Divas 2027: https://telanganatoday.com/pravasi-bharatiya-diwas-2027-to-be-held-in-kolkata